FIX STEPS

Get the bot live on Render and playing music

Based on the screenshots and logs you sent on 1 November 2026. Follow the numbered steps in order. It takes about 15 minutes.

What went wrong (short version)

What you saw	Why it happened
Deploys stuck on **In progress**; logs repeat ==> *No open ports detected on 0.0.0.0*	The **PORT** variable you added had a value the bot could not use, so its web server never started. Render waits for a web server on port 10000, then gives up. Render sets PORT itself, so it should never be added by hand.
In Discord: *Could not stream ...: YouTube is blocking this server's IP*	Render's servers are flagged by YouTube. Your **cookies.txt** was never used: every deploy after you added it got stuck (above), so Render kept running the very first deploy, from **before** the cookies existed.
Could not play ...: ffmpeg exited with code 183	A follow-up of the YouTube error. ffmpeg got no audio. Not a separate problem; the new version no longer shows it twice.

What the new version of the bot does (already on GitHub)

- Ignores a wrong PORT on Render and always opens port 10000, so this can't hang again.
- Checks your **cookies.txt** at startup, repairs common copy/paste damage, and says clearly in the logs if it's unusable.
- Tests YouTube right after login and writes the result to the logs: *[YOUTUBE] Test passed* or *Test FAILED*.
- **If YouTube still blocks a song, it plays the same song from SoundCloud** instead of failing, and posts one short notice in chat.

DO THIS NOW

Step 1: Stop the stuck deploy

1. Open dashboard.render.com > **discord-music-bot** > **Deploys**.
2. If a deploy says **In progress**, click **Cancel** next to it.

Step 2: Delete the PORT variable

1. Left menu: **Environment**. In **Environment Variables**, click **Edit**.
2. Find the row **PORT** and click the **trash/delete icon** at the end of that row.
3. Click **Save only** if you see that option (otherwise **Save and deploy** is fine).

> **Leave everything else as it is**
> Keep TOKEN, GUILD_ID, NODE_VERSION, DEFAULT_VOLUME, LEAVE_WHEN_ALONE_AFTER, LEAVE_WHEN_IDLE_AFTER, MAX_PLAYLIST_SIZE and YTDLP_AUTO_UPDATE. You may add **SOUNDCLOUD_FALLBACK** = **true** but it's already on by default.

Step 3: Replace cookies.txt with a fresh, correct export

Cookies get invalidated when the browser session is used or logged out, so export them fresh. Use a **spare** Google account.

1. Install the Chrome extension **Get cookies.txt LOCALLY** (or **cookies.txt** for Firefox). In Chrome: Extensions > Manage extensions > enable it with **Allow in Incognito**.
2. Open a new **Incognito/Private window**. Go to youtube.com and **sign in** with the spare account. Play any video for a few seconds so YouTube fully trusts the session.
3. In that same tab, open `https://www.youtube.com/robots.txt`.
4. Click the extension icon and choose **Export** (format **Netscape**). A file `www.youtube.com_cookies.txt` downloads.
5. **Close the Incognito window right away.** Do not log out, and don't open YouTube with that account anywhere else.
6. Open the downloaded file in Notepad. Press **Ctrl+A**, then **Ctrl+C**.
7. In Render: **Environment** > **Secret Files** > **Edit**. Click into the contents box of `cookies.txt`, press **Ctrl+A** and **Delete**, then **Ctrl+V** to paste the new contents.
8. Check the **Filename** is exactly `cookies.txt` (lower case, no spaces). Click **Save only** / **Save changes**.

A correct file looks like this (your values are long random strings; there are 7 columns per line):

```
# Netscape HTTP Cookie File
.youtube.com  TRUE  /  TRUE  1801234567  SAPISID          AbCdEf.../xYz
.youtube.com  TRUE  /  TRUE  1801234567  __Secure-3PSID   g.a000...
.youtube.com  TRUE  /  TRUE  1801234567  LOGIN_INFO       AFmmF2sw...
...about 20-30 lines in total...
```

Wrong formats
A file that starts with `[` or `{` is **JSON**. That won't work: export again and choose Netscape.
If you don't see **SAPISID** or **LOGIN_INFO** lines, you weren't signed in when you exported.

Step 4: Deploy the fixed version

1. Go to **Deploys**. Render may have started a deploy of the newest commit by itself (auto-deploy). If one is running, just wait for it.
2. Otherwise click **Manual Deploy** (top right) > **Clear build cache & deploy**.
3. Wait 2 to 4 minutes. The deploy must end with a green **Live** badge. That is the sign the PORT problem is gone.

Step 5: Read the logs

Click **Logs**. A healthy start looks like this:

```
[WEB] Health check on port 10000
[yt-dlp] Ready (version 2026.10.26)
[COOKIES] Loaded 27 YouTube/Google cookies from /etc/secrets/cookies.txt (logged-in account).
[STREAM] Local audio relay listening on 127.0.0.1:34355
[BOT] Logged in as Ustad Marasi#8295 (id ...)
[COMMANDS] Registered 20 slash commands in "The Real World".
==> Your service is live
[YOUTUBE] Test passed: this server can play YouTube.
```

If you see	Do this
`No open ports detected`	Step 2 was not saved. Check Environment: there must be **no** PORT row. Deploy again.
`[WEB] PORT is set to ...`	Harmless now, but delete PORT (Step 2) to get rid of the warning.
`[COOKIES] ... JSON format`	Export again in Netscape format (Step 3).
`[COOKIES] ... do not include a login`	You were signed out when exporting. Repeat Step 3 and sign in first.
`[COOKIES] No YouTube cookies configured`	The Secret File isn't named exactly `cookies.txt`. Fix the name and deploy again.
`[YOUTUBE] Test passed`	Done. YouTube works.
`[YOUTUBE] Test FAILED ... blocking`	YouTube rejected the cookies. Try Step 3 again with a different spare account. Until then, songs play from SoundCloud automatically.

Step 6: Test in Discord

1. Join a voice channel and type `/play shape of you`.
2. You should hear music within about 10 seconds. If YouTube is still blocked, the bot plays it from SoundCloud and posts "*YouTube is blocking this server right now, so songs are being played from SoundCloud instead.*"
3. Try `/radio 90s rock` too: it queues related songs and keeps playing.

Step 7: Keep it online (if you haven't yet)

The free plan sleeps after 15 minutes without web traffic, which takes the bot offline in Discord. Create a free monitor at uptimerobot.com: type **HTTP(s)**, URL `https://discord-music-bot-3ity.onrender.com/healthz`, interval **5 minutes**. That URL now also shows `"youtube": "ok"` or `"blocked"`, which is handy to check from your phone.

> **If YouTube keeps blocking Render**
> Cookies from cloud servers sometimes stop working after a few days. Your options:
> a) Live with the SoundCloud fallback (most popular songs are there).
> b) Refresh cookies when the logs or /healthz say *blocked*.
> c) Run the bot on a home PC instead (main guide, Part 8). Home internet is almost never blocked by YouTube.

Never paste your bot token or cookies into Discord, screenshots or GitHub. If one leaks, reset it (token: Developer Portal > Bot > Reset Token; cookies: sign out of that Google account everywhere, then export new ones).